

Reading a viz → **Build manually** → Build with AI → Write interpretation → AI interpretation → Spot disruption

# Create your first visualization

Activity · Visualizations & Interpretation · ~15 min

## BEFORE YOU START

- ☐ You're signed in and looking at your country's project
- ☐ You're in the **Visualizations** tab
- ☐ You have a folder of your own (or you can use the shared one)

## What you'll do

Create your first chart using the built-in builder: pick a **metric**, choose a **ready-made chart**, and it's saved to the project. You'll click through the builder yourself; the next activity does the same with the AI Assistant.

### 1 Open the visualization builder

In the Visualizations tab, click **+ Create visualization**. A three-step builder opens: **Metric** → **Presets** → **Configure**.

**+ Create visualization**

## 2 Pick a metric

Metrics are grouped by module on the left (M1. Data quality, M3. Service utilization, M4. Coverage...). A metric is **what is measured** — e.g. *Number of services reported, Actual vs expected service volume, Coverage*.

For a service-volume trend, open **M3. Service utilization** and pick a metric such as **Number of services reported**. Click **Next**.

## 3 Choose a ready-made chart

You'll see a grid of **presets** — ready-made charts. Choose **Service volume over time (monthly)** — a line chart of monthly volume by indicator. Click **Create**.

Your chart is created and appears in the **Visualizations** list. Use the **By folder** view to drop it into your folder.

The other presets give quarterly or annual **bar** charts. **Custom → Configure manually** lets you choose the chart type (table, time series, bar, map) and how to break the data down — see the next section.

## Filter vs disaggregate — what's the difference?

These two words come up a lot. They are not the same:

- **Filter = pick what to show.** Choose the indicators, places, or months you want — only those appear. e.g. *show ANC1 only*, or *Northern region only*. Like a spotlight: you point it at what you want to see.
- **Disaggregate = break it down.** Split one total into its parts so you can compare them — e.g. *one line per indicator*, or *one bar per district*. Nothing is hidden; the total is shown as its pieces.

**FILTER** = choose what to show

All indicators are available

☐ ANC1

☐ ANC4

☐ BCG

☐ Penta



You picked ANC1 → only ANC1 shows

☒ ANC1

☐ ANC4

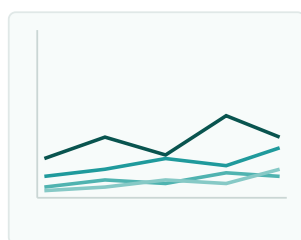
☐ BCG

☐ Penta

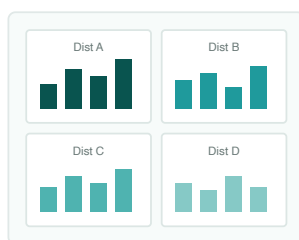
**You pick what you want to see.**

Whatever you don't tick simply isn't shown — like a spotlight.

**DISAGGREGATE “ANC1 by district”** — four ways to display the parts



**Lines**  
one line per district



**Grid**  
a mini chart for each

| District | Visits |
|----------|--------|
| Dist A   | 900    |
| Dist B   | 850    |
| Dist C   | 1,000  |
| Dist D   | 800    |

**Rows**  
one row per district

| Dist A | Dist B | Dist C | Dist D |
|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| 900    | 850    | 1,000  | 800    |

**Columns**  
one column per district

**Example.** Start with *total ANC1 visits, nationally*. **Filter** to "Northern region" → now you see only Northern's ANC1. **Disaggregate** "by district" → the same total split into one bar (or line) per district.

## Where you do this when you edit a viz

Open a saved visualization — the controls live in the **left panel**, and you'll often need to **scroll down** to find them (this is where people get lost). Two sections do the work:

- **Filter (subset)** — **pick what you want to see**: set the time period, and tick the indicator(s) you want. Only what you tick appears.
- **Display (disaggregate)** — choose **how the parts are shown**. The dropdown gives four options:
  - **Lines** — one line per part, all on the same chart
  - **Grid** — a separate little chart for each part, side by side
  - **Rows** — one table row per part
  - **Columns** — one table column per part

| Data                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Presentation | Text |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|------|
| <b>Metric</b><br>Actual vs expected service volume                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |              |      |
| <b>Presentation type</b><br>Timeseries                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |              |      |
| <b>Filter (subset)</b><br><input type="checkbox"/> Data values<br><input checked="" type="checkbox"/> Time period<br><div> <input checked="" type="radio"/> Last N months<br/> <input type="radio"/> From specific month to present<br/> <input type="radio"/> Last N full calendar years<br/> <input type="radio"/> Last N full calendar quarters<br/> <input type="radio"/> Custom         </div> <div>           Number of months = 12           <input type="range"/> </div> |              |      |
| <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> Indicator<br><div> <div>ANC1</div> <div>ANC4</div> <div>BCG</div> <div>DELIVERY</div> <div>OPD</div> </div> <div> <div>PENTA1</div> <div>PENTA3</div> <div>PNC1_MOTHER</div> </div> <div> <div>PNC1_NEWBORN</div> </div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |              |      |
| <b>Display (disaggregate)</b><br><input checked="" type="checkbox"/> Data values (Required for this visualization)<br>Lines                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |              |      |

**Watch out when you use both together.** Here's the trap, with an example. You split a chart **by district** because you want to compare the districts. Then you **filter** it down to just one district — so the others disappear. Now you're looking at a single district on its own, and there's nothing left to compare.

**The simple rule:** use **filter** to pick the data you want to look at, and use **disaggregate** to split it into the parts you want to compare. Just don't filter down to only one of the things you wanted to compare.

## Try a few options

Repeat with a different metric or preset — a coverage metric under **M4**, or the quarterly-change bar chart — to see how each reads.

**Tip:** Line charts (*Service volume over time*) are best for trends over time. Bar charts (*quarterly / annual change*) are better for comparing periods or places. The reference handout *How to read a FASTR visualization* goes deeper.

## Check yourself

You should now have:

- At least one chart created and visible in your **Visualizations** list
- The path in muscle memory: **+ Create visualization → Metric → Presets → Create**
- A sense of which presets suit trends vs comparisons

## What's next

The next activity does the same thing using the AI Assistant — typing a request in plain language instead of clicking through the builder. Same end result, different path.

 **Verify in your current UI:** labels (*+ Create visualization, Create*) may differ slightly. The **Metric → Presets → Create** path is the key structure.